

The best way to improve your **speaking** skills is to talk to native speakers.

speaking

[the ability to communicate using spoken language]



Looking at American websites can help you improve your English **reading** skills.

reading

[the ability to understand written materials]



I understand some Hebrew, but find the **writing** impossible.

writing

[the ability to communicate using written words]



English acts as a **lingua franca** for the people at the conference.

a lingua franca

[a shared language that allows people from various countries to understand each other]



The **translation** of the contract was full of mistakes.

a translation

[a piece of writing that has been changed from one language to another]



The **language barrier** stopped me from talking to Wen.

the language barrier

[difficulty communicating with someone who speaks another language]



After only a few weeks living in Italy, I was able to **make myself understood**.

to make yourself understood

[to be able to express basic information and ideas to people]



Although Pedro has a strong accent, he does **speak accurately**.

to speak accurately

[to speak without making mistakes]



Living in Cairo, I managed to **pick up** Arabic **quickly**.

to pick something up quickly

[to be able to learn something in little time]



I **have a good ear for languages**. I learned Swahili in six months.

to have a good ear for languages

[to be able to understand languages without difficulty]

